Eliq Loop Interview — Ghid de pregătire

Toate poveștile în format STAR explicit · Română + English spoken versions

Formatul: 3 interviuri × 45 min, 3 intererviewери, fiecare acoperă 2 din 14 principii. Întrebări comportamentale, răspuns STAR, 2–3 min, în **engleză**. Interviewerii își compară notele după — **nu repeta aceeași poveste la doi oameni**. După Loop: 2–3 referințe pregătite.

STAR: S **Situation** — contextul și de ce conta · T **Task** — responsabilitatea/obiectivul TĂU · A **Action** — ce ai făcut TU, nu echipa · R **Result** — cifră sau fapt concret

Partea 1 · Cele 14 Leadership Principles

01 · Focus on the customer

"We start with the customer, whether an end user or an enterprise client, and work backwards from there."

RO: Pornești de la impactul asupra utilizatorului, lucrezi înapoi spre soluție.

Întrebare probabilă: *"Tell me about a time when customer feedback changed your solution."*

Capcană: să vorbești doar despre stakeholderi interni. · **Povestea ta: E**

02 · Be curious

"We are committed to lifelong learning and are always looking for new ways to grow."

RO: Înveți continuu din proprie inițiativă și transformi ce înveți în rezultate.

Întrebare: *"What have you learned recently, on your own initiative?"*

Capcană: "citesc bloguri" — vag; dă exemplu cu rezultat. · **Povestea ta: G sau C**

03 · Take ownership

"We take ownership beyond our own team… we never say 'that's not my job'."

RO: Rezolvi probleme care nu sunt ale tale, pentru că sunt ale firmei.

Întrebare: *"Tell me about a time you fixed something that wasn't your responsibility."*

Capcană: povești unde de fapt ți s-a cerut. Trebuie NEcerut + urmărit până la închidere. · **Povestea ta: B**

04 · Disagree, and commit

"We speak up and challenge ideas respectfully… once a decision is made, we commit to it fully."

RO: Contești cu date ÎNAINTE de decizie; execuți total DUPĂ, chiar dacă ai pierdut.

Întrebare: *"Tell me about a time you disagreed with a decision. What did you do after?"*

Capcană: "am avut dreptate și m-au ascultat" = vindicare, nu commit. · **Povestea ta: F**

05 · Deliver

"We focus on what matters most and deliver quality results, on time. When we hit setbacks, we keep going."

RO: Calitate LA TERMEN; obstacolele nu opresc livrarea și nu scad calitatea.

Întrebare: *"Tell me about a deadline you almost missed. How did you prioritize?"*

Capcană: "am muncit nopțile" — semnal negativ. · **Povestea ta: D**

06 · Hire and develop the best

"We raise the bar with every hire… we take coaching seriously and invest in helping people grow."
RO: Faci oamenii din jur mai buni — mentorat, standarde, documentație care ridică echipa.
Întrebare: "*How have you helped someone grow?*"
Capcană: doar documente, fără niciun om concret în poveste. · **Povestea ta: H**

07 · Earn trust

"We listen closely, communicate honestly and own our mistakes openly."
RO: Îți asumi greșelile primul, comunici onest inclusiv veștile proaste.
Întrebare (GARANTATĂ): "*Tell me about your biggest mistake.*"
Formula: greșeală reală → detectată de tine → fix imediat → fix sistemic → ce faci diferit azi. · **Povestea ta: C** (rezervă: branch prefix)

08 · Think big

"Big results start with a bold vision… we are not afraid to take a calculated risk."
RO: Nu optimizezi task-ul — schimbi sistemul. Risc calculat = reversibil și măsurat.
Întrebare: "*Tell me about a time you proposed something beyond what was asked.*" · **Povestea ta: G**

09 · Be frugal

"We treat time and money as resources to use carefully, not carelessly."
RO: Tratezi timpul tău ca pe banii firmei; constrângerile te fac creativ.
Întrebare: "*Tell me about a time you accomplished more with less.*" · **Povestea ta: C** — diferențiator: frugalitate măsurată pe propria muncă.

10 · Invent and simplify

"We keep innovating and look for ways to simplify our products, processes and experiences."
RO: Simplificarea e invenție: cod șters, straturi eliminate, procese cu mai puțini pași.
Întrebare: "*Tell me about something you simplified.*" · **Povestea ta: D sau G**

11 · Dive deep

"We get into the details, check our assumptions and stay sceptical when something does not add up."
RO: Când datele nu se leagă, sapi până la mecanism. Nu accepți "nu se poate reproduce".
Întrebare: "*Tell me about a problem where the data didn't add up.*"
Cheie: procesul de investigație pas cu pas, nu doar concluzia. · **Povestea ta: A**

12 · Be right, a lot

"We use data to guide decisions… we seek out different perspectives and test our own thinking."
RO: Verifici înainte să afirmi; când datele te contrazic, schimbi poziția fără orgoliu.
Întrebare: "*How do you test your own thinking?*"
Obiceiul tău: feedback de review → verific sursa/log-urile CI înainte să răspund. · **Povestea ta: F sau A**

13 · Take action

"We act quickly and decisively, especially when a decision is reversible."
RO: Reversibil → rapid. Ireversibil → încetinești. Spune distincția explicit — e limbajul lor.
Întrebare: "*Tell me about a time you acted with incomplete information.*" · **Povestea ta: E**

14 · Insist on the highest standards

"We keep raising the bar on quality… when something goes wrong, we fix it fast and thoroughly."

RO: Refuzi "merge și așa". Fixezi cauza și CLASA de probleme, nu instanța.

Întrebare: "*Tell me about a time you refused to accept 'good enough'.*" · **Povestea ta: A sau B**

Povestea A — „Testele minteau" / "The tests were lying"

Principii: Dive deep · Insist on the highest standards · Be right, a lot

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** Bug de producție: pagina îngheța la utilizatori într-un flow de editare. Toate cele ⚠️ 184 de teste ale componentei — verzi. Reflexul echipei: „nu se poate reproduce".

T **Task:** Eram responsabil de fix. Am refuzat premisa că teste verzi = cod corect.

A **Action:** Am reprodus fluxul real în browser → am izolat momentul crash-ului → cauza: un efect reactiv declarat în constructorul componentei rula ÎNAINTE ca input-ul de formular să fie setat → crash la acces. De ce nu prindeau testele: fiecare test pre-popula formularul în setup — condiția din producție (formular absent la prima execuție) nu era NICIODATĂ testată. Ordinea corectă: întâi test adversarial care reproduce condiția reală → confirmat că pică → apoi guard de readiness.

R **Result:** Bug eliminat la rădăcină. Regulă nouă în echipă: pattern-ul cere guard + test adversarial — devenit criteriu de code review. Clasa de bug eliminată, nu doar instanța.

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

> **S** "We had a production bug where a page would freeze for users during editing — but all 184 unit tests for that component were green. The team's first instinct was 'cannot reproduce.'"
>
> **T** "I owned the fix, and I refused the premise that green tests meant correct code — something had to be wrong with our confidence, not just with the code."
>
> **A** "I reproduced the user's actual flow in the browser, isolated the exact moment of the freeze, and traced the root cause: a reactive effect declared in the component's constructor was executing *before* the form input was set — crashing on a form that didn't exist yet. Then the more interesting question: why did 184 tests miss it? I read the test setup and found every single test pre-populated the form before rendering. The exact production condition was never tested — the green suite was false confidence. I fixed it in the right order: first an adversarial test reproducing the real condition, confirmed it failed, then the readiness guard."
>
> **R** "The bug was fixed at the root, and I turned it into a team rule: that pattern now requires a guard plus an adversarial test, enforced as a code-review criterion. We didn't fix one bug — we eliminated the class."

Follow-ups de așteptat: "How exactly did you find it?" (pașii din Action) · "How long did it take?" (⚠️ pregătește durata) · "How did you enforce the rule?" (criteriu de review, documentat).

Povestea B — „Credențialele din log" / "The credentials in the log"

Principii: Earn trust · Take ownership · Insist on the highest standards

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** Lucram la altceva și am observat în log-urile unui job de CI că username-ul și parola de autentificare erau printate în plaintext — vizibile oricui avea acces la run-uri.

T **Task:** Nu era ticketul meu, nu era pipeline-ul meu. Puteam s-o ignor — am tratat-o ca pe jobul meu, pentru că era securitatea firmei.

A **Action:** Am documentat exact run-ul și jobul afectat → raportat imediat cu dovezi → am insistat pe ROTAȚIA credențialelor (fix-ul de cod oprește doar expunerea viitoare; secretul era deja vizibil istoric = compromis) → am propus fix-ul corect cu secrets masking → am urmărit până la închidere.

R **Result:** Vulnerabilitate închisă înainte de exploatare. Lecția: la incidente de securitate, fix-ul de cod e jumătatea ușoară; expunerea istorică cere rotație, și cineva trebuie să insiste pe asta.

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

> S "While working on something unrelated, I noticed one of our CI jobs was printing authentication credentials — username and password — in plaintext in the job logs. Anyone with access to pipeline runs could read them."
>
> T "It wasn't my ticket and it wasn't my pipeline. But it was the company's security, so I treated it as my job."
>
> A "I documented the exact run and job affected and reported it immediately with evidence. The part I think matters most: I insisted on rotating the credentials, not just fixing the code — fixing the logging only stops future exposure; the secret had already been visible in historical logs, so it had to be treated as compromised. I proposed the proper fix with secrets masking, and I followed up until it was actually closed — reporting alone isn't ownership."
>
> R "The vulnerability was closed before anyone exploited it. My takeaway: in security incidents the code fix is the easy half — the historical exposure is what people forget, and someone has to be the person who insists on it."

Follow-ups: "Why didn't you fix it yourself?" → fix-ul de cod l-am propus; rotația cerea acces/decizie pe care nu le aveam — corect era escaladarea cu dovezi. · "What happened after you reported?" → onest, inclusiv dacă ai insistat a doua oară. · ⚠️ "How long had it been exposed?"

Povestea C — „Post-mortem pe mine însumi" / "The post-mortem on myself"

Principii: Be frugal · Be curious · Earn trust · (și la "biggest mistake")

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** Am terminat un refactor care a costat de multe ori mai mult decât merita — proces greu de orchestrare aplicat unui task mecanic de câteva fișiere. Ticket închis, teste verzi, nimeni nu mi-a reproșat nimic.

T **Task:** Eu nu eram mulțumit — mi-am făcut singur post-mortem, nesolicitat.

A **Action:** Am descompus unde s-a dus efortul: ⚠️ (1) orchestrare/coordonare inutilă pentru un task mic, (2) verificări redundante pe fiecare pas, (3) overhead de proces. Total ~70% waste. Am schimbat SISTEMUL: praguri de dimensionare (task mecanic sub ~10 fișiere → cale directă; peste sau cu risc arhitectural → proces complet) + gate-uri de cost la care mă opresc și reevaluez. Am împărtășit analiza cu echipa, cu cifrele jenante cu tot.

R **Result:** Task-uri echivalente ulterioare: fracțiune din cost și timp. Meta-lecția: îmi tratez timpul ca pe o resursă a firmei — waste-ul e waste chiar dacă nu-ți trimite nimeni factura.

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

> **S** "Last year I finished a refactor and realized it had cost several times more than it should have — I'd applied our heavyweight process, designed for large risky changes, to what was essentially a mechanical task across a handful of files. The ticket was done, tests green, everyone happy."
>
> **T** "But I wasn't happy. Nobody called me out — so I ran a post-mortem on my own work, unprompted."
>
> **A** "I broke down where the effort had gone: orchestration a small task didn't need, redundant verification at every step, pure process overhead — roughly seventy percent of total effort was waste. Then I changed my system, not just my mood: explicit sizing thresholds — a mechanical task under roughly ten files goes the direct lightweight path, anything larger or architecturally risky gets the full process — plus cost gates where I stop and re-evaluate instead of pushing through. And I shared the analysis with the team, embarrassing numbers included."
>
> **R** "Equivalent tasks afterwards cost a fraction of the time. The bigger lesson: treat my own time with the same frugality I'd apply to the company's money — waste is waste even when nobody sends you the invoice."

Follow-ups: "Where exactly did the 70% go?" (ai descompunerea) · "Give me the thresholds." (~10 fișiere) · "Did you share it?" (da — cum).
⚠️ **Dublă utilizare:** C acoperă și Be frugal, și "biggest mistake". Dacă ambele pică la ACELAȘI interviewer → rezerva pentru mistake: prefix greșit de branch → CI blocat, PR închis → "*Small mistake, useful lesson: I'd relied on memory for a process contract. Now, before any action with a fixed contract, I re-read the guideline. Checklists beat memory.*"

Povestea D — „Refactorul mare livrat" / "Delivering the big migration"

Principii: Deliver · Invent and simplify

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** Modulul de consolidare financiară rula pe o arhitectură veche care bloca evoluția platformei. Aplicație enterprise: o regresie = cifre greșite pentru un client.

T **Task:** Am condus/executat migrarea end-to-end pe fundația nouă — fără să oprim dezvoltarea de features, fără regresii. ⚠ Termen: [durata reală + respectat/nu].

A **Action:** Secvență de pași mici, independent verificabili — fiecare complet verde înainte de următorul. Am SIMPLIFICAT pe drum, nu doar mutat: straturi legacy șterse complet ⚠ [N linii / 2 straturi]. Migrarea a scos la iveală 8 buguri preexistente — tentația era „out of scope"; le-am fixat. ⚠ Setback concret: [un bug blocant / o dependență] → [cum l-ai tratat].

R **Result:** Livrat ⚠ [la termen / în estimare], ~1.800 de teste verzi, acoperire completă pe codul nou. Modulul e mai SIMPLU după migrare decât înainte — testul real al unui refactor.

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

> **S** "Our financial consolidation module was running on a legacy architecture that was blocking the platform's evolution — in an application used by enterprise finance teams, where a regression means wrong numbers for a customer."
>
> **T** "My job was to migrate it end-to-end to the new foundation — without stopping feature development and without regressions. [Termen: ⚠]"
>
> **A** "I structured it as a sequence of small, independently verifiable steps — each fully green before the next. That discipline made the risk manageable. Two things I'd highlight: first, I simplified as I migrated instead of relocating code — I deleted the legacy layers entirely, [N lines removed]. Second, the migration surfaced eight pre-existing bugs hiding in the old structure; the tempting move was 'out of scope' — I fixed them, because shipping a clean foundation with known bugs isn't delivering quality. One concrete setback: [⚠ obstacolul] — [cum l-ai rezolvat]; the step-by-step structure kept it from cascading."
>
> **R** "Delivered [on time / within estimate], with around 1,800 tests green and full coverage on the new code. And the module is simpler now than before the migration — which to me is the real test of a refactor."

Follow-ups: "How long did it take?" ⚠ · "YOUR part vs the team's?" (clarifică din prima frază) · "What setback?" (pregătește UNUL concret).

Povestea E — „Deblocarea utilizatorului" / "Unblocking the accountant"

Principii: Focus on the customer · Take action

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** Bug raportat: după salvare, utilizatorii nu mai puteau edita câmpuri — blocați până la refresh manual. Utilizatorii = contabili; în perioada de închidere salvează de zeci de ori pe zi → flux rupt constant, în cel mai prost moment.

T **Task:** Fix-ul rapid trata simptomul din ticket. Am judecat de la utilizator înapoi.

A **Action:** Am parcurs fluxul REAL al utilizatorului, nu cei 3 pași din raport: editează → salvează → continuă → se răzgândește → anulează → editează iar. Așa am găsit cauza (stare stătută de formular persistentă după salvare) ȘI un al doilea caz nemenționat în ticket: calea de cancel/reset avea aceeași problemă — utilizatorul ar fi lovit-o a doua zi. Le-am fixat pe ambele.

R **Result:** Livrat în ⚠️ [zile], ~56 de teste incluzând calea neraportată. Zero re-deschideri pe ticket. Lecția: ticketul descrie ce a OBSERVAT utilizatorul, nu tot ce e stricat.

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

> S "We got a bug report: after saving, users couldn't edit fields anymore — the form stayed locked until a full page refresh. On paper it looks minor. But our users are accountants, and during a financial close they save dozens of times a day — this was breaking their workflow constantly, at the worst possible time."
>
> T "The quick fix would have been to patch the symptom in the ticket. I decided to work backwards from the user instead."
>
> A "I walked through the flow the way the user actually works — not the three steps in the bug report, but the real sequence: edit, save, keep working, change your mind, cancel, edit again. That's how I found the root cause — stale form state persisting after save — and also a second case the ticket never mentioned: the cancel-and-reset path had the same problem. Nobody had reported it, but an accountant would have hit it the very next day. I fixed both."
>
> R "Shipped within [days], covered with about fifty-six tests including the unreported path. Zero reopens on that ticket. The lesson: 'the customer comes first' isn't reading the ticket carefully — it's walking in the user's actual shoes, because the ticket describes what they noticed, not everything that's broken."

Follow-ups: "How did you know about the cancel case?" (am parcurs fluxul complet ca un contabil) · "How fast did you ship?" ⚠️

Povestea F — „Dovada în locul opiniei" / "Evidence over opinion"

Principii: Disagree and commit · Be right, a lot · Earn trust

⚠️ **INCOMPLETĂ** — completează înainte de interviu: ce cerea reviewerul + cine a avut dreptate.

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** La un PR al meu, un reviewer ⚠️ [senior / alt team] a cerut o schimbare pornind de la o presupunere despre comportamentul la runtime / un semnal din CI: ⚠️ [ce cerea concret].

T **Task:** Nu voiam nici să implementez pe încredere (era senior, pushback-ul era inconfortabil), nici să resping din orgoliu. Ambele sunt opinii — voiam fapte.

A **Action:** Am trasat calea reală din codul-sursă și am extras log-urile din CI run-ul concret. Am adus dovada în thread — nu „cred că", ci „iată linia, iată log-ul".

R **Result:** Aliniere într-un schimb de mesaje, nu zile de dezbatere. ⚠️ [Varianta 1: dovada a arătat că presupunerea nu ținea → schimbarea nu era necesară. / Varianta 2 (mai bună pt. Earn trust): dovada i-a dat DREPTATE reviewerului → am implementat convins, nu resemnat.] Regulă personală de atunci: orice claim de review care presupune comportament la runtime → verific sursa/log-urile înainte să răspund.

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

S "During review on one of my pull requests, a senior reviewer asked me to change [the approach], based on an assumption about how the system behaved at runtime — [presupunerea]."

T "My honest first instinct was to just implement it — they were senior, and pushing back felt uncomfortable. But I didn't want to change it on trust, and I didn't want to reject it on ego either. Both of those are opinions. I wanted facts."

A "So I went and got them: I traced the actual source code path in question, and pulled the logs from the specific CI run to see what really happened at runtime. I brought the evidence into the review thread — not 'I think', but 'here is the line, here is the log output.'"

R "[Var. 1:] The evidence showed the assumption didn't hold; we aligned in a couple of messages and the change wasn't needed. [Var. 2:] The evidence proved the reviewer right — the best outcome, because I implemented the change fully convinced instead of quietly resentful. Since then it's a personal rule: any review claim that assumes runtime behavior, I verify against source or logs before responding. Disagreement gets settled by evidence, not seniority — in either direction."

Povestea G — „Schimbarea sistemului de lucru" / "Changing how the team works"

Principii: Think big · Be curious · Invent and simplify

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** Testarea E2E și verificarea manuală erau scumpe pentru toată echipa — fiecare feature replătea același cost repetitiv de verificare. Majoritatea își optimizează task-ul propriu.

T **Task:** Mi-am propus să schimb SISTEMUL, nu task-ul.

A **Action:** Am construit workflow-uri de automatizare cu AI tooling: verificare în browser, generare de teste, review-uri pe niveluri. CHEIA: n-am automatizat doar producția, am automatizat și VERIFICAREA — gate-uri de calitate, straturi de review, teste care validează output-ul (automatizarea fără verificare produce greșeli mai repede). Risc calculat: abordare nedovedită, dar REVERSIBILĂ — dacă pica, pierdeam câteva zile din timpul meu, nu un release. Am măsurat: comparație pe task-uri echivalente înainte/după.

R **Result:** ⚠️ ~70% reducere de cost pe fluxurile acoperite. Muncă manuală per-ticket → proces repetabil, documentat. ⚠️ Adopția: [cine îl folosește / „în curs, prin documentare și demo-uri, nu prin mandate"].

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

> **S** "End-to-end testing and manual verification were expensive for the whole team — every feature paid the same repetitive verification cost, over and over."
>
> **T** "Most people optimize their own task. I set out to change the system instead."
>
> **A** "I built automation workflows around AI tooling: browser-based verification, test generation, layered reviews. The part I care most about — because it's the first question any skeptic should ask — is that I didn't just automate producing work, I automated verifying it: quality gates, review layers, tests validating the output. Automation without verification just produces mistakes faster. It was a calculated risk in exactly the sense I like: unproven approach, fully reversible — if it failed I'd lose a few days of my own time, not a release. And I measured it rather than trusting the feeling, comparing equivalent tasks before and after."
>
> **R** "Verification cost dropped roughly seventy percent on the covered workflows. What used to be per-ticket manual work is now a repeatable, documented process. [Adopție onestă:] Adoption is still growing — I drive it through documentation and demos, not mandates, because a process people don't understand is a process they abandon."

Follow-ups garantate: "How did you measure 70%?" (metodologia) · "How do you guarantee AI output quality?" (verificarea automatizată — punctul tău forte) · "Is the team using it or just you?" ⚠️ (onest)

Povestea H — „Standardele care lucrează și fără mine" / "Standards that work without me"

Principii: Hire and develop the best · Earn trust

⚠️ **INCOMPLETĂ** — obligatoriu de adăugat UN OM CONCRET înainte de interviu. Fără el, povestea pică la follow-up-ul garantat: "*But have you grown a person, directly?*"

Română (STAR)

S **Situation:** Echipă distribuită; cunoștințe critice (convenții de testare, workflow-uri, standarde de review) trăiau în capul oamenilor. Fiecare inginer nou — și fiecare coleg pe zonă nefamiliară — replătea costul învățării de la zero.

T **Task:** Standardul echipei să nu depindă de prezența mea în cameră.

A **Action:** (1) Am scris ghidurile de testare ale echipei — piramida completă: ce aparține de unit vs. component vs. E2E, cu reguli concrete de plasare — folosite ca referință la scriere ȘI la review. (2) Am documentat workflow-ul E2E pas cu pas — oricine produce teste la același standard, nu doar „cei care știu". (3) La code review dau CONTEXTUL, nu doar corecția — arăt regula/dovada, ca următorul PR al aceluiași om să nu mai aibă problema. Review = transfer de cunoștințe, nu gard.

R **Result:** ⚠️ [OBLIGATORIU omul concret: un coleg a livrat primul lui test E2E doar pe ghid, fără mine / onboarding făcut de tine / demo ținut echipei]. Asta înseamnă ridicarea ștachetei ca inginer: sistemele și oamenii pe care îi lași mai buni decât i-ai găsit.

English (spoken, STAR — ~2 min)

> **S** "In a distributed team, our critical knowledge — testing conventions, workflows, review standards — lived in people's heads. Every new engineer, and honestly every existing one touching an unfamiliar area, paid the learning cost again from scratch."
>
> **T** "My goal was that the team's standard should not depend on me being in the room."
>
> **A** "Three things. First, I wrote the team's testing guides — the full pyramid strategy: what belongs in a unit test versus a component test versus end-to-end, with concrete placement rules — now the reference for both writing and reviewing tests. Second, I documented our end-to-end workflow step by step, so anyone produces tests at the same standard, not just the people who 'know how it's done.' Third — the everyday one — in code reviews I give the context, not just the correction: when I push back, I show the rule or the evidence, so that person's next PR doesn't repeat the issue. Review as knowledge transfer, not gatekeeping."
>
> **R** "A concrete example: [⚠️ OMUL — e.g. 'a colleague shipped their first end-to-end test entirely from the guide, without needing me']. To me that's what raising the bar means as an engineer: the systems and people you leave better than you found them."

Partea 3 · Întrebările-capcană (răspunsuri STAR)

"Tell me about your biggest mistake" — GARANTATĂ

Folosește **Povestea C** (are deja STAR complet mai sus). Formula: greșeală reală → detectată de MINE → fix imediat → fix sistemic → ce fac diferit azi.

Rezerva (dacă C e deja folosită la același interviewer) — mini-STAR:

> **S** "I once opened a PR from a branch with a prefix that didn't match our process contract."
>
> **T** "CI blocked it and the PR had to be closed — small consequence, but self-inflicted and avoidable."
>
> **A** "I'd relied on memory for a process contract. I re-read the guideline, redid the branch properly, and changed my habit: before any action with a fixed contract — branch naming, release steps — I re-read the guide first."
>
> **R** "Never repeated it. Lesson: checklists beat memory."

"What's your weakness?"

NU slăbiciune-fake. A ta, reală + mecanism de compensare:

> *"My tendency is to go too deep technically before shipping incrementally — I over-invest in understanding. I've learned to set explicit cost and time gates where I stop and re-evaluate. It's the same discipline that came out of my post-mortem story."*

"Why Eliq? / Why are you leaving?"

60 de secunde POZITIVE. **Niciodată negativ despre angajatorul actual** — e test de Earn trust deghizat.

> *"I want to work on a product where the impact is direct and measurable — helping people understand and reduce their energy consumption is exactly that. I'm drawn to the scale of the data problem and to a smaller team where ownership is real, not diluted. [⚠️ + motivul tău personal]"*

Partea 4 · Întrebările TALE (2–3 per interviu, nu repeta)

Interviu 1:

- *"What does success in this role look like after six months — concretely, in terms of deliverables?"*
- *"Which of the fourteen principles is the hardest to live up to in practice at Eliq, and why?"* ← *cea mai puternică*

Interviu 2:

- *"How are contested technical decisions actually made here — who has the final call, and what does disagree-and-commit look like in a real recent example?"*
- *"What surprised you after joining Eliq?"*

Interviu 3:

- *"What's the team's biggest technical challenge in the next year?"*
- *"How do you measure impact on the end user — which metrics move the product team?"*

Partea 5 · Matricea poveste × principiu

Principiu	Principal	Rezervă
01 Focus on the customer	**E**	D (miza enterprise)
02 Be curious	**G**	C
03 Take ownership	**B**	C
04 Disagree and commit	**F**	— (completeaz-o!)
05 Deliver	**D**	E
06 Hire and develop	**H**	G (demo/adopție)
07 Earn trust	**C**	B
08 Think big	**G**	D
09 Be frugal	**C**	G
10 Invent and simplify	**D**	G
11 Dive deep	**A**	F
12 Be right, a lot	**F**	A
13 Take action	**E**	B
14 Highest standards	**A**	B

Regula de aur: notează după fiecare interviu ce povești ai folosit. A, C, D, G sunt cele mai „cerute" — distribuie-le pe interviuri diferite.

Partea 6 · Reguli pentru ziua interviului

- **"I", not "we."** Contribuția TA. Dacă a fost echipa, spune explicit bucata ta.
- **2–3 minute, apoi taci.** Vor detalii → întreabă ei (scrie chiar în ghidul lor).
- **Fiecare Result = o cifră** sau un fapt verificabil.
- **Pauza e OK** — ghidul lor: "*It's fine to pause and think.*"
- **Onestitate despre imperfecțiuni** — ghidul lor: "*Being honest about what you'd do differently is often more convincing than a perfect story.*"
- **Nu repeta povești** între intervieweri — își compară notele.
- **Distincția reversibil/ireversibil** la Take action — e limbajul lor.
- **Referințe:** 2–3 persoane, deja anunțate.

Partea 7 · Checklist final

□ Verificat cifrele ⚠️ : 184 teste (A) · durata investigației (A) · expunerea istorică (B) · pragurile (C) · durata migrării (D) · liniile șterse (D) · zilele de livrare (E) · 56 teste (E) · metodologia 70% (G)
□ Completat F: ce cerea reviewerul + cine a avut dreptate
□ Completat H: omul concret
□ Scris "Why Eliq" personal (60 sec)
□ Fiecare poveste spusă cu voce tare 1×, cronometrat ≤2½ min
□ Capcanele (mistake, weakness) spuse cu voce tare 1×
□ Referințele anunțate
□ Citit produsul Eliq 15 min: energy insights API, clienți utilities, piețe (UK, Nordics)